

GlobalTrust Financial Services

Mortgage Processing Guide

Mortgage Operations Department

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1. Purpose

This Mortgage Processing Guide establishes standardised procedures for residential and commercial mortgage origination, approval, settlement, and post-disbursement monitoring at GlobalTrust Financial Services (GTFS). Non-mortgage lending is governed by the Loan Approval SOP (GTFS-OPS-001).

- **Customer experience** — Transparent timelines; mortgage approval SLA of 7 business days.
- **Risk mitigation** — LTV limits, valuation controls, and stress testing per GTFS-RISK-001.
- **Regulatory compliance** — KYC (GTFS-COMP-002), AML (GTFS-COMP-001), and MAS housing guidelines.
- **Operational efficiency** — Defined SLAs for valuation (3 days) and legal verification (5 days).
- **Property security** — Title registration within 14 business days; insurance mandatory before disbursement.

LEGAL REMINDER: Property insurance is mandatory before disbursement. No funds may be released without confirmed fire and mortgagee insurance in place.

2. Scope

- Residential Mortgages, Commercial Mortgages, Refinancing, Construction Loans, Buy-to-Let Mortgages.
- Mortgage Operations, Relationship Managers, Legal, Valuation, Credit, Risk, Settlement Team.
- All GTFS mortgage centres in Singapore, Dubai, Mumbai, and London.

3. Mortgage Products

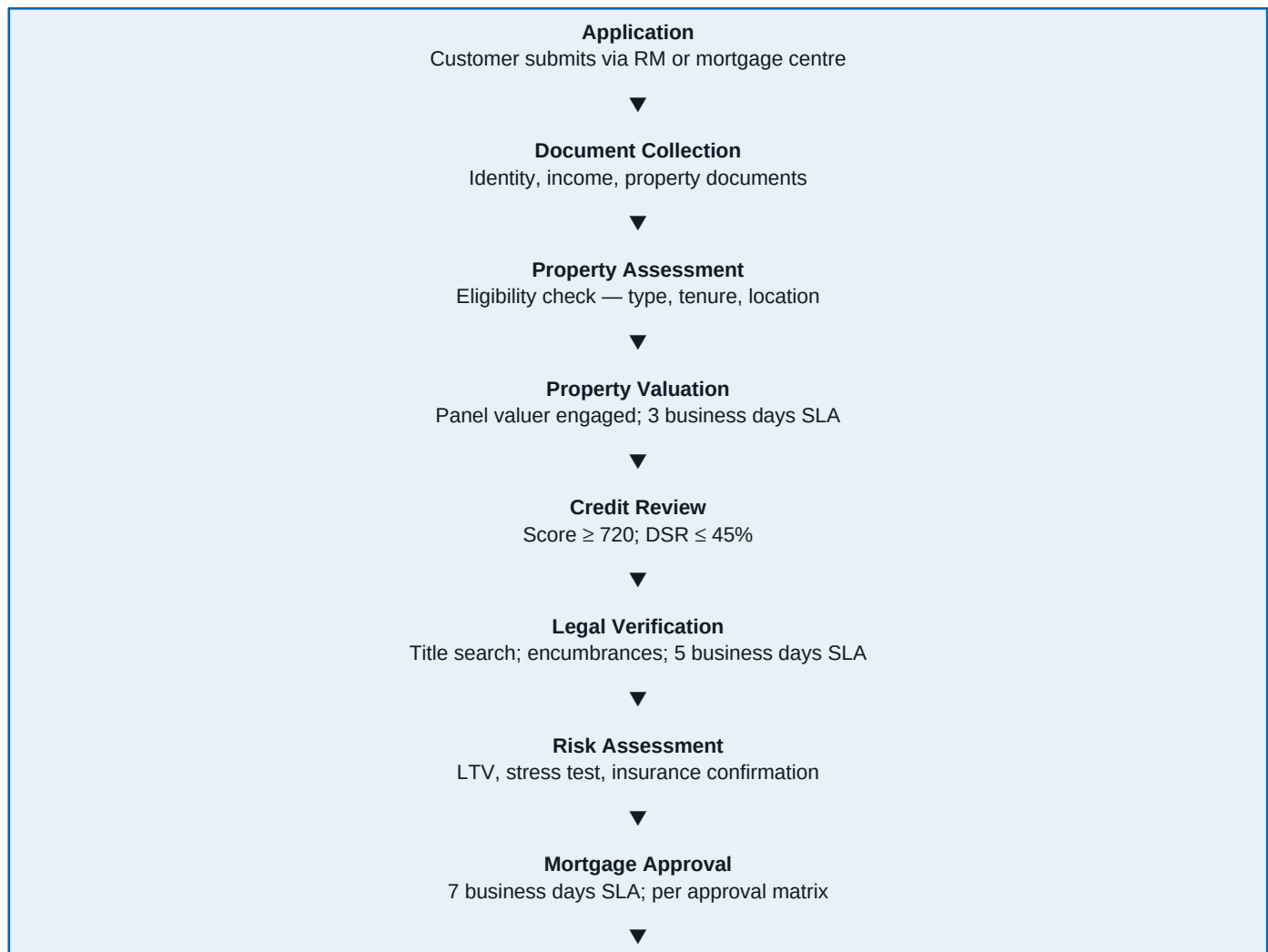
Product	Description	Max Tenure	Typical LTV
Fixed Rate Mortgage	Interest rate fixed for lock-in period	30 years (residential)	80% first-time / 75% existing
Floating Rate Mortgage	Rate linked to benchmark (e.g. SORA)	30 years (residential)	80% first-time / 75% existing
Construction Loan	Progressive disbursement for build	30 years	Per approved draw schedule
Home Equity Loan	Second charge on existing property	15 years	Up to 75% combined LTV
Refinancing	Switch from existing lender	Remaining tenure (max 30 years)	75% maximum LTV
Commercial Mortgage	Income-producing commercial property	20 years	65% maximum LTV
Bridge Financing	Short-term pending sale or refinance	12–24 months	Case-by-case
Buy-to-Let	Investment residential property	30 years	75% maximum LTV

IMPORTANT: Early repayment penalty of 2% applies during the first 3 years on fixed-rate products. Disclose penalty terms in the offer letter.

4. Roles & Responsibilities

Role	Primary Responsibilities
Mortgage Officer	Application intake; document collection; customer liaison
Relationship Manager	Customer relationship; referral; eligibility pre-screen
Property Valuation Team	Panel valuer coordination; valuation review (3-day SLA)
Legal Department	Title search; legal opinion; registration (5-day SLA)
Credit Analyst	Credit bureau; affordability; DSR assessment
Underwriter	Risk rating; LTV validation; stress testing
Risk Officer	Policy compliance per GTFS-RISK-001
Operations	File management; disbursement coordination
Settlement Team	Lawyer coordination; fund release; title registration

5. End-to-End Mortgage Workflow



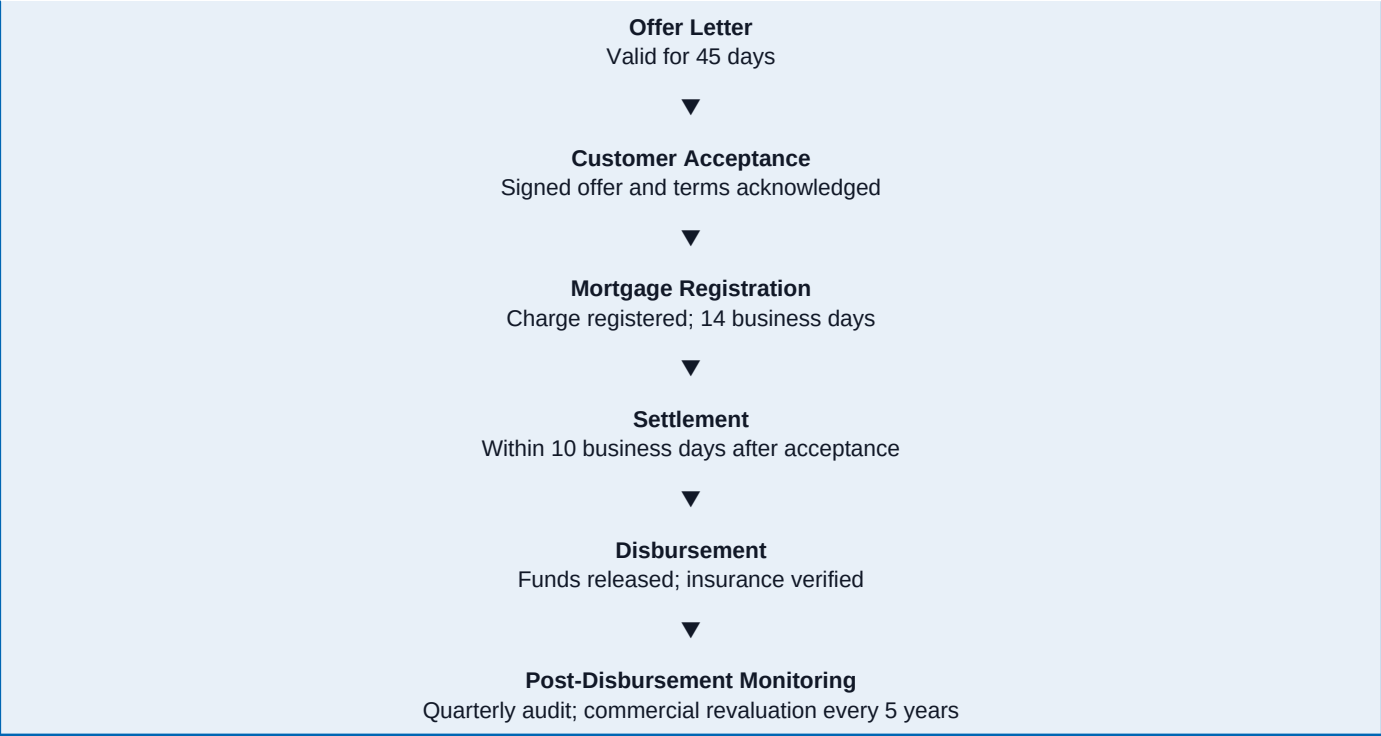


Figure — Typical Residential Mortgage Timeline

Day 1–2 Application & docs	Day 3–5 Valuation (3 days)	Day 5–10 Legal (5 days)	Day 7 Approval SLA	Day 10–20 Settlement (10 days)	Day 14–24 Title registration
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6. Customer Eligibility

Criterion	Requirement	Verification Method
Minimum Applicant Age	21 years	NRIC / Passport
Maximum Age at Maturity	70 years	Tenure calculation at application
Minimum Credit Score	720	Internal score + bureau
Maximum Debt Service Ratio	45%	Income vs total debt obligations
Income Assessment	Stable verifiable income	Salary slips, tax returns, employer letter
Employment Verification	Minimum 12 months (salaried)	Employer letter, CPF/contribution records
Business Income	2 years audited accounts	Financial statements, tax returns
Existing Loans	Included in DSR calculation	Credit bureau, internal records
Credit History	No recent defaults or bankruptcies	Bureau report
Nationality	Singaporean, PR, or eligible foreigner	Passport, visa, KYC per GTFS-COMP-002

MORTGAGE TIP: Applicants must not exceed 70 years of age at loan maturity. Maximum residential tenure is 30 years; commercial is 20 years.

7. Property Eligibility

Property Type	Eligible	LTV Limit	Notes
Residential — Completed	Yes	80% FTB / 75% existing	HDB and private residential
Residential — Under Construction	Yes	Progressive disbursement	Developer must be on approved list
Commercial Property	Yes	65% maximum LTV	Revaluation every 5 years
Leasehold	Yes	Tenure must exceed loan tenure	Legal years of lease terms
Freehold	Yes	Standard LTV applies	Preferred security type
Mixed Use	Case-by-case	Lower of residential/commercial LTV	Mortgage Committee approval
Buy-to-Let	Yes	75% maximum LTV	Rental income may support DSR

LTV Comparison

Borrower Profile	Maximum LTV	Minimum Down Payment
First-Time Buyer (residential)	80%	20%
Existing Property Owner (residential)	75%	25%
Commercial Property	65%	35%
Refinancing (existing owner)	75%	25%

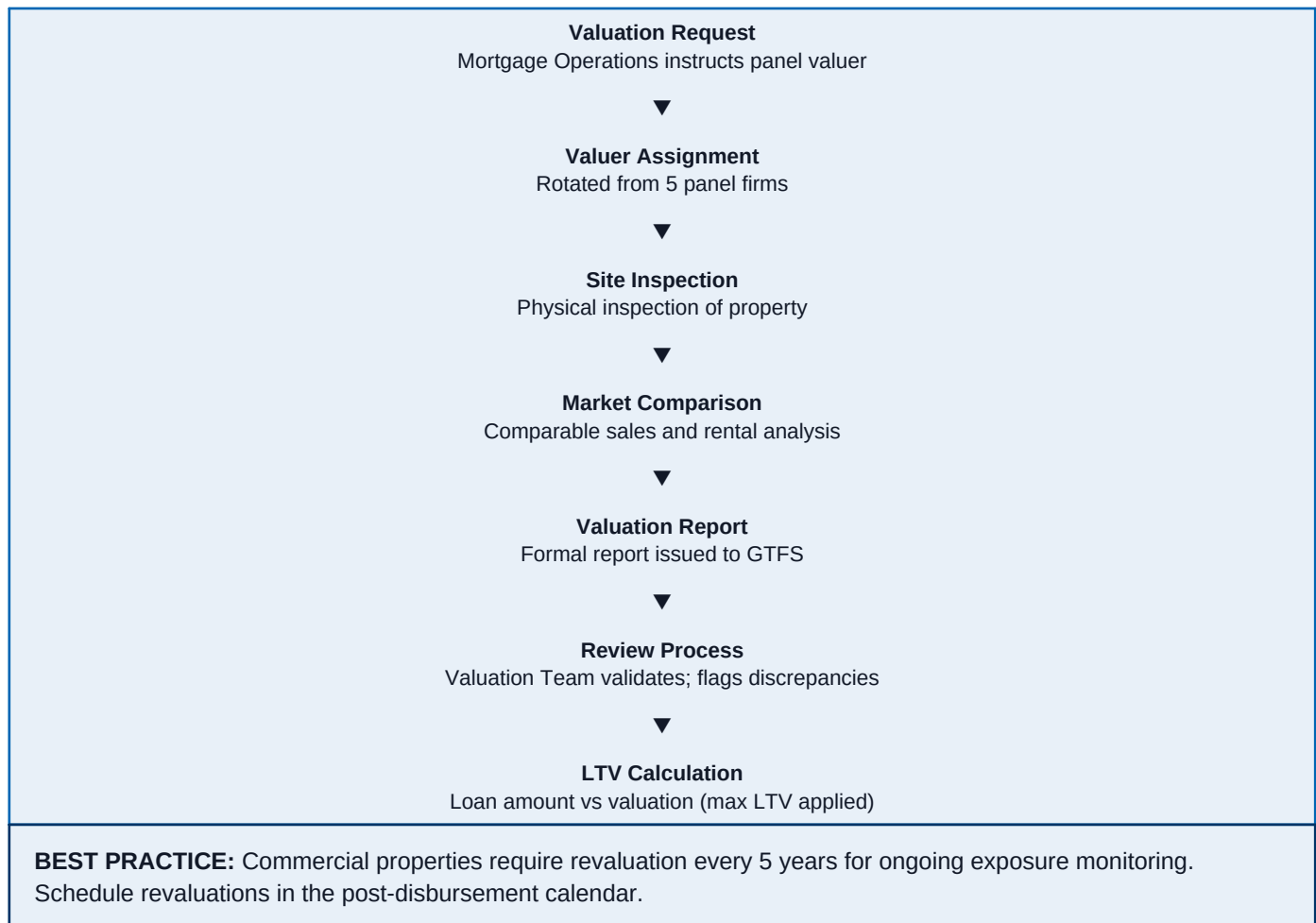
8. Required Documents

Document	Residential	Commercial	Refinancing
Identity Documents	NRIC/Passport (GTFS-COMP-002)	Directors + UBO IDs	Borrower ID
Income Proof	Salary slips (3 months)	Audited financials (2 years)	Updated income proof
Bank Statements	Last 12 months	Business accounts 12 months	Last 12 months
Property Sale Agreement	Option to Purchase / SPA	Sale & Purchase Agreement	N/A if refinance
Property Title	Title deed / search	Title deed / search	Existing title + redemption statement
Valuation Report	Panel valuer (90-day validity)	Panel valuer (90-day validity)	New valuation if > 90 days
Insurance	Fire + mortgagee (mandatory)	Property + liability insurance	Updated insurance
Tax Documents	IRAS notice of assessment	Corporate tax returns	Latest NOA
Employer Letter	Employment confirmation	N/A (business income)	If employment changed

9. Property Valuation

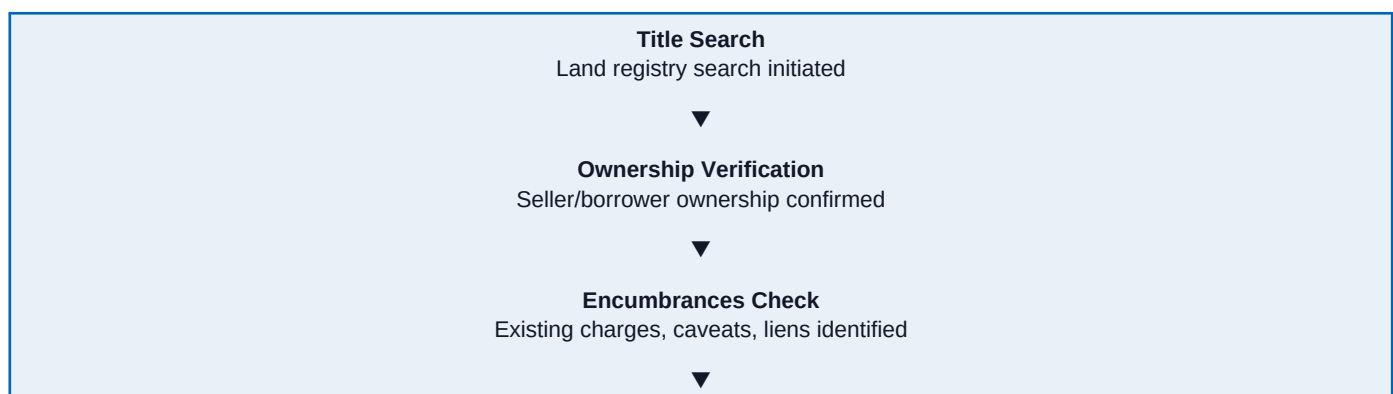
Property valuations must be conducted by one of **5 approved panel valuation firms**. Valuation reports are valid for **90 days**. Property Valuation SLA is **3 business days**.

Property Valuation Process



10. Legal Verification

Legal Verification Flow



Legal Opinion
GTFS legal counsel issues opinion



Mortgage Registration
Charge prepared for registration



Settlement Preparation
Completion documents drafted



Registration Complete
Within 14 business days of settlement

LEGAL REMINDER: Legal Verification SLA is 5 business days from receipt of complete title documents. Incomplete title packs are the primary cause of settlement delays.

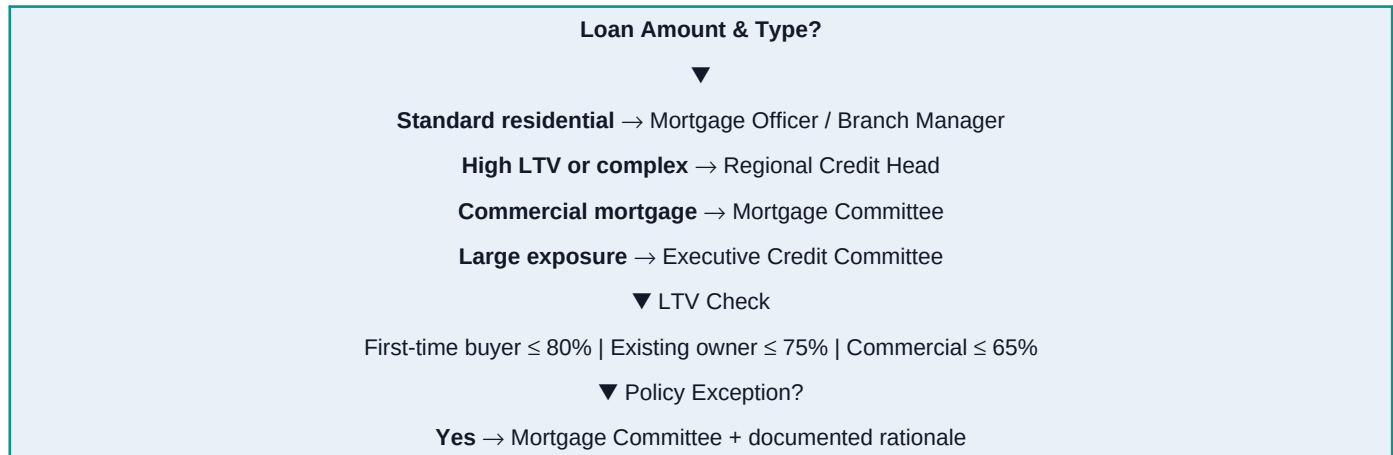
11. Credit & Risk Assessment

Assessment Element	Standard	Method
Internal Credit Score	Minimum 720	Proprietary mortgage scoring model
External Bureau	Mandatory pull	CBS / equivalent
Affordability	DSR $\leq$ 45%	Gross income vs all debt obligations
Loan-to-Value	Per LTV matrix	Loan amount $\div$ valuation
Debt Service Ratio	$\leq$ 45% including new mortgage P&I + existing debt / income	
Stress Testing	+2% rate shock	Per GTFS-RISK-001 credit risk guidelines

IMPORTANT: Stress testing at +2% interest rate is mandatory. Applications failing stress test must be declined or restructured unless Mortgage Committee approves exception.

12. Mortgage Approval Matrix

Figure — Mortgage Approval Decision Tree



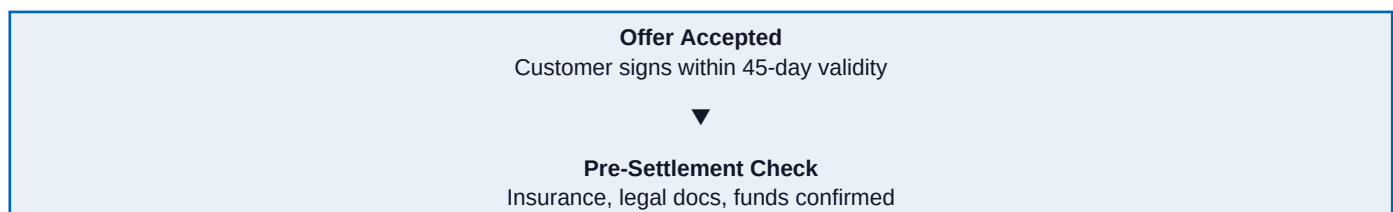
Approver	Authority	Conditions
Mortgage Officer	Standard residential within policy	LTV, score, DSR all within limits
Branch Manager	Residential up to regional limits	Full documentation on file
Regional Credit Head	High LTV or complex residential	Underwriter recommendation
Mortgage Committee	Commercial mortgages; policy exceptions	Committee quorum required
Executive Credit Committee	Large exposures; syndicated facilities	Per GTFS-FIN-001 limits

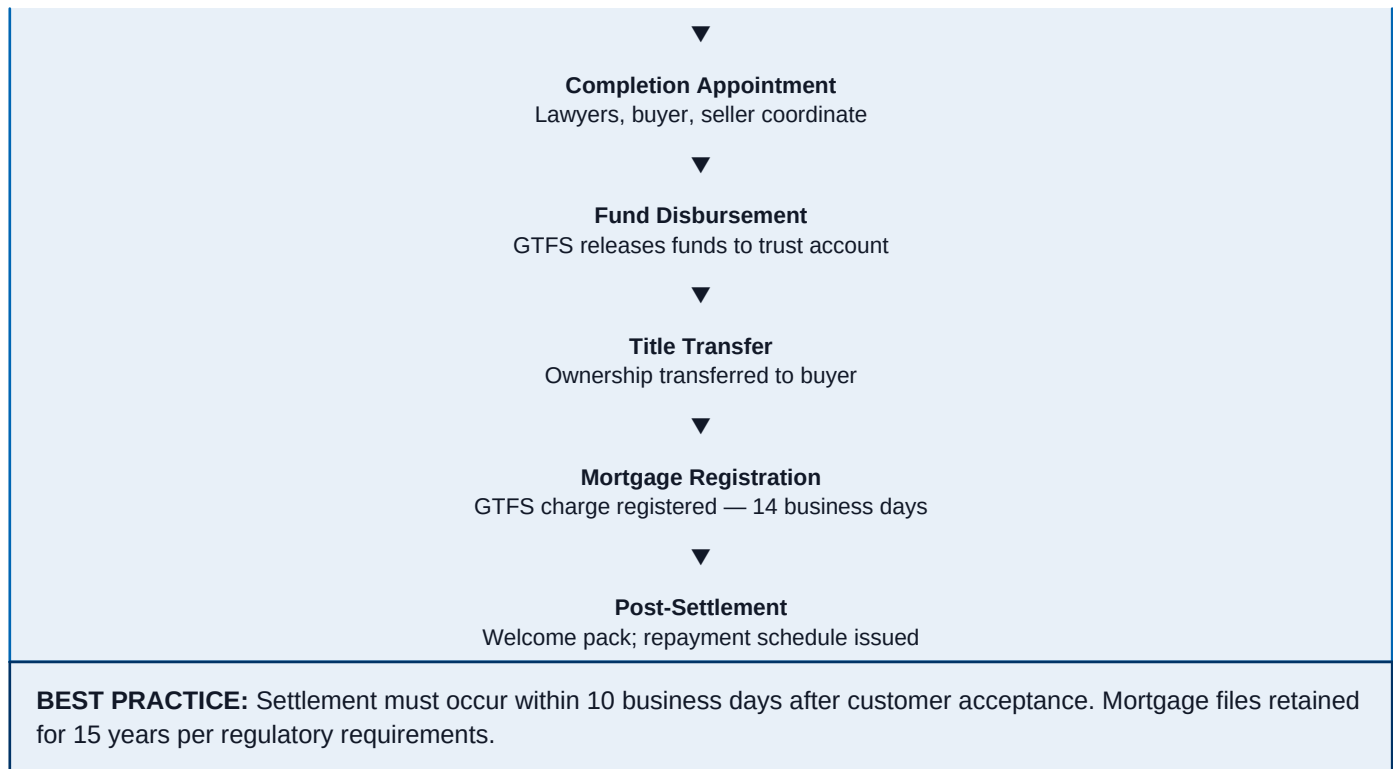
Mortgage Approval SLA: 7 business days from complete application.

13. Settlement & Disbursement

Step	Responsible	Requirement	Timeline
Settlement Checklist	Settlement Team	All conditions satisfied	Pre-settlement
Insurance Confirmation	Operations	Property insurance mandatory	Before disbursement
Lawyer Coordination	Settlement Team	Completion appointment scheduled	Per completion date
Fund Release	Operations / Treasury	Disbursement to lawyer trust account	Settlement day
Customer Notification	RM / Mortgage Officer	Confirmation letter issued	Same day
Title Registration	Legal	Charge registered at land registry	Within 14 business days

Settlement Workflow



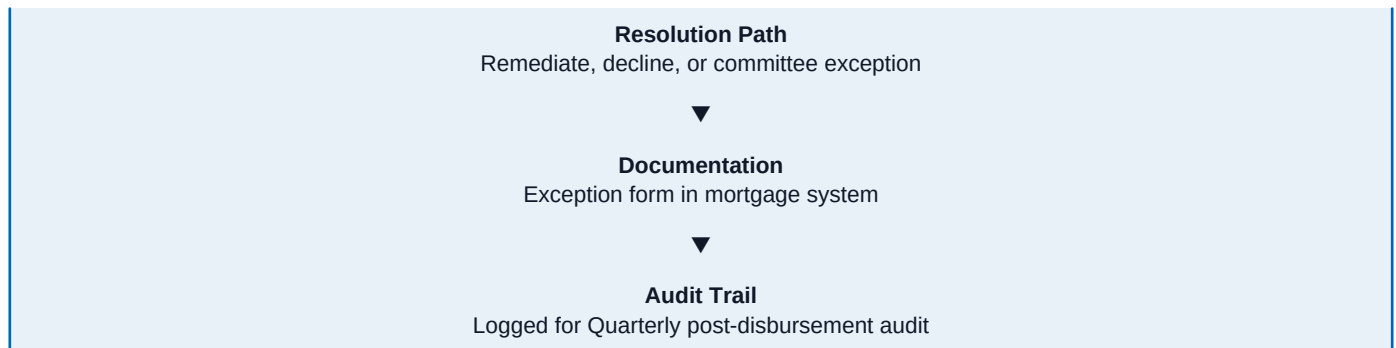


14. Exception Handling

Exception Type	Procedure	Escalation
Incomplete Documents	Return to customer with deficiency list; clock paused	Mortgage Officer
Property Disputes	Hold processing; legal review	Legal + Mortgage Committee
Fraud Detection	Freeze file; STR per GTFS-COMP-001	Compliance immediately
Title Issues	Legal opinion; may require indemnity or decline	Legal Department
Insurance Delays	Cannot disburse until confirmed	RM follows up with customer
Policy Exceptions	Document rationale; committee review	Mortgage Committee

Exception Escalation Workflow





Mortgage Processing Case Studies

Case Study: First-Time Home Buyer

Scenario: Singapore couple, ages 28 and 30, purchasing HDB resale flat for SGD 650,000.

Assessment: Credit scores 735 and 728. DSR 38%. LTV 80% (SGD 520,000 loan). Down payment 20%.

Approval Process: Approved by Mortgage Officer within policy limits.

Timeline: Valuation: 3 days. Legal: 5 days. Approval: 6 days. Settlement: 8 days after acceptance.

Outcome: Mortgage disbursed successfully. Title registered in 12 business days.

Lessons Learned: First-time buyer LTV of 80% applied correctly; 20% down payment verified.

Case Study: Commercial Property Purchase

Scenario: SME owner purchasing shophouse for SGD 2.8 Million. Loan SGD 1.82 Million (65% LTV).

Assessment: Business income verified over 24 months. Commercial tenure 20 years. Score 722.

Approval Process: Mortgage Committee approval required for commercial product.

Timeline: Valuation: 3 days. Legal: 5 days. Committee: 7 days. Settlement: 10 days.

Outcome: Approved with quarterly covenant monitoring. Revaluation scheduled in 5 years.

Lessons Learned: Commercial LTV capped at 65%; 35% down payment confirmed.

Case Study: Mortgage Refinancing

Scenario: Existing owner refinancing SGD 480,000 outstanding from competitor bank.

Assessment: Property valued at SGD 720,000. LTV 67% (within 75% existing owner limit). Score 740.

Approval Process: Approved by Branch Manager. Redemption statement verified.

Timeline: New valuation ordered (previous report expired). Total processing: 14 business days.

Outcome: Refinanced at lower rate. Early repayment penalty not applicable (competitor loan).

Lessons Learned: Valuation validity of 90 days — always check report date on refinances.

Case Study: Construction Loan

Scenario: Customer building landed property. Progressive disbursement over 18 months.

Assessment: Developer on approved list. Valuation on land + construction cost. Score 725.

Approval Process: Mortgage Committee approval for construction product.

Timeline: Initial approval: 7 days. Drawdowns per construction milestones.

Outcome: First drawdown disbursed after foundation completion inspection.

Lessons Learned: Construction loans require milestone inspections before each disbursement.

Case Study: Rejected Property

Scenario: Applicant seeking mortgage on property with active caveat from third party.

Assessment: Legal search revealed unresolved ownership dispute. Title not marketable.

Approval Process: Application declined by Legal Department recommendation.

Timeline: Legal verification completed in 4 days. Decline communicated immediately.

Outcome: Application declined. No disbursement. Customer referred to legal counsel.

Lessons Learned: Title issues must be resolved before processing — never proceed with caveats.

Case Study: Fraudulent Property Documents

Scenario: Operations flagged forged Option to Purchase during document verification.

Assessment: Compliance notified. AML re-screening per GTFS-COMP-001. Property did not exist at stated address.

Approval Process: Application frozen. STR filed. Declined.

Timeline: Immediate escalation. Investigation within 24 hours.

Outcome: Declined. Customer referred to Compliance. File retained 15 years.

Lessons Learned: Verify property address against land registry before valuation instruction.

15. Frequently Asked Questions

Q: Maximum LTV for first-time buyers?

A: 80% — minimum down payment 20%.

Q: Maximum LTV for existing property owners?

A: 75%.

Q: Maximum LTV for commercial property?

A: 65% — minimum down payment 35%.

Q: Minimum credit score for mortgages?

A: 720.

Q: Maximum debt service ratio?

A: 45%.

Q: How long is a valuation report valid?

A: 90 days.

Q: How long is the mortgage offer valid?

A: 45 days.

Q: Is property insurance required?

A: Yes — mandatory before disbursement.

Q: Property valuation SLA?

A: 3 business days.

Q: Legal verification SLA?

A: 5 business days.

Q: Mortgage approval SLA?

A: 7 business days.

Q: Settlement timeline after acceptance?

A: Within 10 business days.

Q: Title registration timeline?

A: Within 14 business days.

Q: Mortgage file retention period?

A: 15 years.

Q: Commercial property revaluation frequency?

A: Every 5 years.

Q: Early repayment penalty?

A: 2% during first 3 years on fixed-rate products.

Q: Maximum residential tenure?

A: 30 years.

Q: Maximum commercial tenure?

A: 20 years.

Q: Minimum applicant age?

A: 21 years.

Q: Maximum age at loan maturity?

A: 70 years.

Q: How many approved valuation vendors?

A: 5 panel firms.

Q: Post-disbursement audit frequency?

A: Quarterly.

Q: Where is non-mortgage lending documented?

A: GTFS-OPS-001 Loan Approval SOP.

Q: KYC requirements?

A: GTFS-COMP-002 KYC Guidelines — complete before credit assessment.

Q: Who approves commercial mortgages?

A: Mortgage Committee.

16. Appendices

Appendix A — Mortgage Checklist (Residential)

- Application form signed
- KYC complete (GTFS-COMP-002)
- Credit score ≥ 720
- DSR $\leq 45\%$
- Applicant age ≥ 21 ; maturity age ≤ 70
- Valuation report (90-day validity) from panel firm
- Legal verification complete (5-day SLA)
- Property insurance confirmed
- Offer letter accepted within 45 days
- Settlement within 10 business days
- Title registration within 14 business days

Appendix B — Mortgage Timeline Summary

Stage	SLA / Timeline	Owner
Property valuation	3 business days	Valuation Team
Legal verification	5 business days	Legal Department
Mortgage approval	7 business days	Credit / Underwriting
Offer validity	45 days	Mortgage Operations
Settlement	10 business days after acceptance	Settlement Team
Title registration	14 business days	Legal Department
File retention	15 years	Operations
Post-disbursement audit	Quarterly	Mortgage QA

Appendix C — Property Valuation Checklist

- Valuer assigned from 5 panel firms
- Site inspection completed
- Market comparison documented
- Report dated and signed
- Report within 90-day validity
- LTV calculated against valuation
- Commercial: revaluation date scheduled (+5 years)

Appendix D — Mortgage Glossary

Term	Definition
LTV	Loan-to-Value — loan amount as percentage of property value
DSR	Debt Service Ratio — maximum 45% for GTFS mortgages

Term	Definition
FTB	First-Time Buyer — eligible for 80% LTV
SPA	Sale and Purchase Agreement
Panel Valuer	One of 5 GTFS-approved valuation firms
Charge	Registered mortgage security on property title
Stress Test	+2% rate shock applied to affordability assessment

Appendix E — Department Contacts

Function	Contact
Mortgage Operations	mortgage-ops@gtfs.internal
Property Valuation	valuation@gtfs.internal
Legal — Mortgages	legal-mortgage@gtfs.internal
Settlement Team	settlement@gtfs.internal
Mortgage Committee Secretariat	mortgage-committee@gtfs.internal

COMMON PROCESSING ERROR: Processing a mortgage without valid valuation (within 90 days) or confirmed insurance is a Common Processing Error that triggers immediate QA escalation.

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